state's ability to gear up its military preparedness and improvise its military capabilities, which in turn determines its foreign policy objectives.

Military Preparedness: Military capability is the most determining factor as far as national power and prestige is concerned. Russia, the United States and China have huge army under their command as compared to Iceland, Costa Rica, Maldives, Mauritius and other small countries. Manpower backed by sophisticated technology and upgradation through continuous research and development is what makes a state militarily strong and powerful. The US high-tech war during the 1991 Gulf War brought about revolutionary changes and introduced new thinking in the history of warfare. It symbolized radical changes from strategy, to research and development to procurement, so much so, that other states had to rethink about the efficacy of their military establishment. Therefore possession of conventional forces as well as nuclear arsenal gives certain leverage to states in negotiation with others. Exhibition of sheer military might projects the prowess and prestige of a state.

National Character and National Morale: Though many scholars disregard the importance of national character as an important input of foreign policy because of its metaphysical overtones yet national character finds expression in international relations through the perceptions, reactions and behavioural patterns of decision-makers. As Prof. Jayantanuja Bandyopadhyaya suggests that, if worship of wealth and power are regarded as chief attributes of American national character, the foreign policy becomes logically one, which is consistent with these attributes. In India, the culture and belief system has moulded the outlook and foreign policy perspective of the decision-makers.

National Morale: It is also an elusive category and consists of a state of mind, which sometimes can be called **patriotism or love of country.** Morgenthau opined, "National Morale is the degree of determination with which a nation supports the home and foreign policies of its government in times of peace or war. It permeates all activities of a nation, its agricultural and industrial production as well as its military establishment and diplomatic service". Willingness to